

Earbuds under ₹5,000



Worth the money

Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in

The under-₹5,000 price bracket in the world of TWS earbuds has been highly competitive for a couple of years. On one hand, we have products from established brands in the audio business like Sennheiser, Jabra, JBL, and the. On the other hand, there are brands like Samsung, OnePlus, Oppo, and realme, trying to get a foothold in the territory ruled by these players. Offerings from these brands include realme Buds Air 3 and the Buds Air Pro, OnePlus Nord Buds and the Buds Z2, and the Samsung Galaxy Buds Live. All of these pose a problem of plenty for consumers when they are out in the market. But, to make sure that you do not face such an issue, here's a list of the Top 10 TWS earbuds under ₹5,000.



Sennheiser CX True Wireless Earbuds

Coming from the house of Sennheiser are the CX True Wireless earbuds. They retail for around ₹5,000 on e-commerce websites and often drop down to about ₹4,500. These earbuds

are the most well-rounded of the lot, followed closely by the Jabra Elite 5. The CX True Wireless earbuds lack ANC but make up for its absence with their sound signature, battery life, and build quality. Like most other earbuds in this price range, they have a slight boost in the lows (bass) and mids (vocals), but the overall response is well-rounded. With sweat resistance also baked in, these earbuds also make for a great purchase for all you fitness enthusiasts reading this.

Jabra Elite 3

The lowest-end earbuds in Jabra's arsenal, the Jabra Elite 3 came very close to the Sennheiser's offering. Their fit, microphone performance, and sound signature is slightly better than the CX TWS, with the bass, mids, and treble being balanced out pretty well. However, with their 7 hour battery life, they lost significant ground. The build quality of the case is



also something that also held them back from claiming the top spot in this list. These earbuds have physical buttons instead of the commonly found capacitive/touch-sensitive buttons, and you get nice tactile feedback when you are trying to trigger an action.



Sony WF-C500

Sony's WF-C500 TWS earbuds secured the third spot in this list. These earbuds lack ANC but have a great fit, build quality, and sound, which despite being slightly on the warmer side (bass boosted), sounds better than others lower in the list. Not to

forget their battery life, which at about 9 hours and 50 minutes, puts most other earbuds on this list to shame. Just like the Jabra Earbuds, they have physical buttons on the earbuds, which you can use to trigger actions and control the music playback. In relatively silent environments, their microphone performance is also decent. If you are a stickler for aesthetics, then there's the translucent lid of their case, which helps them stand out.



Samsung Galaxy Buds Live

While the design helps the Samsung Galaxy Buds Live stand out, it is also what pulls them down. I'd highly recommend that you try them out before buying. If that is sorted, then you'll get pair that has punchy bass, tamed-

down mids, and slightly boosted highs. Overall, their sound signature is not the best, but definitely serviceable for the price. In terms of battery life, these earbuds, with ANC on, you can expect around 5 hours and 30 minutes of run time, with the case providing about two and a half rounds of charging. Talking about the case, it matches the colour of the earbuds, has a nice shine to it, and has great build quality and ease of opening and closing.